

9.2 Data dashboard taxonomies

Dashboards can be classified in various ways. Businesses may use data dashboards that fall into multiple of the following categories or do not fall into any of the categories. The following categories are not exhaustive.

Static dashboards

- are relatively inexpensive and easy to develop
- are generally updated infrequently
- provide information which may be updated manually as new data/information is collected/analysed
- are useful when KPIs change slowly.

Dynamic dashboards

- take more time and effort to develop
- are generally updated frequently (sometimes continuously)
- are useful when new and revised data is received regularly and quickly incorporated into the dashboard
- are useful when KPIs change rapidly.

Non-interactive dashboards

- are useful when relevant data does not change frequently
- do not allow users to customise the display.

Interactive dashboards

- allow users to customise the display and filter the data that is displayed
- offer users interactivity in various ways:
 - *drilling down* – allows users to obtain more specific and detailed information on a variable of interest
 - *hierarchical filtering* – allows users to restrict data displayed to a specific segment by selecting variables in a nested manner
 - *time-interval widget* – allows users to specify the time period that is displayed
 - *customisation tools* – allows users to choose the categories and/or variables that are displayed on the dashboard.

Operational dashboards

- are typically used by lower-level managers
- are used to monitor rapidly changing critical business conditions
- generally update in real time or many times during the working period.

Tactical dashboards

- are typically used by mid-level managers
- are used to identify/assess organisational strengths and weaknesses to support development of organisational strategies
- are generally updated less frequently.

Strategic dashboards

- are typically used by executives
- are used to monitor the status of KPIs relevant to the overarching objectives of the organisation
- are generally updated on a recurring basis but at less frequent intervals.

Analytical dashboards

- are typically used by analysts
- are used to identify and investigate trends, predict outcomes and uncover insights in data.

□ Watch: Dashboard design tips [6.56 mins]

This video is useful as it discusses the need to understand the purpose of the dashboard, how the dashboard will be accessed and the actions that users may take. It also describes three major types of dashboards and how colour can be used.

As you watch, consider:

- How could knowing the purpose of the dashboard influence its design?
- Why is understanding the user's needs and designing for their needs essential?



Source: © Pierluigi Giglio (2021).

□ Activity: Check your understanding of data dashboard taxonomies

Can you describe the different categories of dashboards? Click on the + icons in the image below to see if you were right!

